

Required Report: Required - Public Distribution

Date: April 02, 2026

Report Number: SF2026-0009

Report Name: Oilseeds and Products Annual

Country: South Africa - Republic of

Post: Pretoria

Report Category: Oilseeds and Products

Prepared By: Dirk Esterhuizen

Approved By: Oliver Flake

Report Highlights:

South Africa's oilseed sector is set for continued growth and expansion in marketing year 2026/27, with record production, crush, and exports highlighting its increasing importance and competitiveness in the country's agricultural sector. Oilseed production is forecast to reach a historic high, driven by expanded plantings of soybeans and rapeseed, while sunflower seed output remains stable. Further expansion of local crushing capacity has enabled unprecedented domestic production of oilseed meal and oils, with surplus meal increasingly exported to regional markets. Increased domestic oilseed oil production has significantly reduced South Africa's reliance on imported vegetable oils, although imports are expected to remain a vital component of the edible oil market. Despite these gains, growth in domestic feed consumption is likely to remain limited due to ongoing biosecurity and economic challenges that continue to constrain the production and demand of poultry and livestock products.

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Executive Summary

The Oilseeds and Products Annual Report provides an overview of production, supply, and distribution trends for soybeans, sunflower seed, rapeseed, oilseed meal, and oilseed oil in South Africa for marketing years (MY¹) 2026/27, 2025/26, and 2024/25.

- **Production Forecasts:** The Foreign Agricultural Service in Pretoria (FAS/Pretoria) projects that South Africa's oilseed area will reach a record level in MY 2026/27, with total production expected to achieve an all-time high. This expansion is driven by increased area for soybeans and rapeseed, both reaching historic peaks, while sunflower area remains stable.
- **Crushing and Processing:** Higher domestic oilseed output will support record crushing volumes in MY 2026/27, fully utilizing South Africa's expanded processing capacity. This is expected to result in unprecedented production of both oilseed meal and oilseed oil.
- **Consumption and Demand:** Feed consumption is anticipated to grow modestly, reflecting ongoing biosecurity challenges and subdued demand for poultry and livestock products. FAS/Pretoria also forecasts limited growth in plant oil consumption due to continued constraints on consumer purchasing power.
- **Trade:** Oilseed exports are projected to remain strong in MY 2026/27, while imports are expected to remain minimal as domestic production continues to exceed local utilization needs. South Africa is set to export record volumes of oilseed meal, mainly soybean meal, to neighboring countries. By contrast, the country will continue to rely on imports of plant oils, primarily palm oil, to meet domestic demand.
- **Economic Challenges:** Economic growth is expected to remain sluggish, with persistently high unemployment. Ongoing policy uncertainty and logistical infrastructure challenges continue to impede economic development and limit the potential for accelerated consumption growth.

¹ The MY's used in the text refers to the USDA marketing years in the Production, Supply and Distribution (PS&D) tables, and do not necessarily correspond with the marketing years used by the South African grain industry.

Oilseeds

Table 1: Soybean Production, Supply, and Distribution

Oilseed, Soybean Market Year Begins South Africa	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
	Mar 2025		Mar 2026		Mar 2027	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	1200	1200	1200	1220	0	1255
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	1151	1151	1185	1213	0	1255
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	245	245	321	290	0	250
Production (1000 MT)	2771	2800	2600	2730	0	2800
MY Imports (1000 MT)	30	12	50	0	0	0
Total Supply (1000 MT)	3046	3057	2971	3020	0	3050
MY Exports (1000 MT)	300	247	450	250	0	250
Crush (1000 MT)	1825	2210	1850	2300	0	2320
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	25	20	25	20	0	20
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	575	290	350	200	0	200
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	2425	2520	2225	2520	0	2540
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	321	290	296	250	0	260
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	3046	3057	2971	3020	0	3050
Yield (MT/HA)	2.4075	2.4327	2.1941	2.2506	0	2.2311
(1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Table 2: Sunflower seed Production, Supply, and Distribution

Oilseed, Sunflower seed Market Year Begins South Africa	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
	Mar 2025		Mar 2026		Mar 2027	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	560	560	560	570	0	560
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	556	556	560	570	0	560
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	70	70	66	41	0	47
Production (1000 MT)	708	700	720	778	0	730
MY Imports (1000 MT)	70	68	15	10	0	20
Total Supply (1000 MT)	848	838	801	829	0	797
MY Exports (1000 MT)	20	15	1	20	0	10
Crush (1000 MT)	750	770	725	750	0	730
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	2	2	2	2	0	2
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	10	10	8	10	0	10
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	762	782	735	762	0	742
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	66	41	65	47	0	45
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	848	838	801	829	0	797
Yield (MT/HA)	1.2734	1.259	1.2857	1.3649	0	1.3036
(1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Table 3: Rapeseed Production, Supply, and Distribution

Oilseed, Rapeseed Market Year Begins South Africa	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
	Oct 2025		Oct 2026		Oct 2027	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	165	166	170	175	0	185
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	166	166	175	175	0	185
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	11	11	18	9	0	23
Production (1000 MT)	290	290	312	309	0	330
MY Imports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Supply (1000 MT)	301	301	330	318	0	353
MY Exports (1000 MT)	90	68	80	40	0	50
Crush (1000 MT)	175	220	210	250	0	270
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	18	4	18	5	0	5
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	193	224	228	255	0	275
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	18	9	22	23	0	28
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	301	301	330	318	0	353
Yield (MT/HA)	1.747	1.747	1.7829	1.7657	0	1.7838
(1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)						
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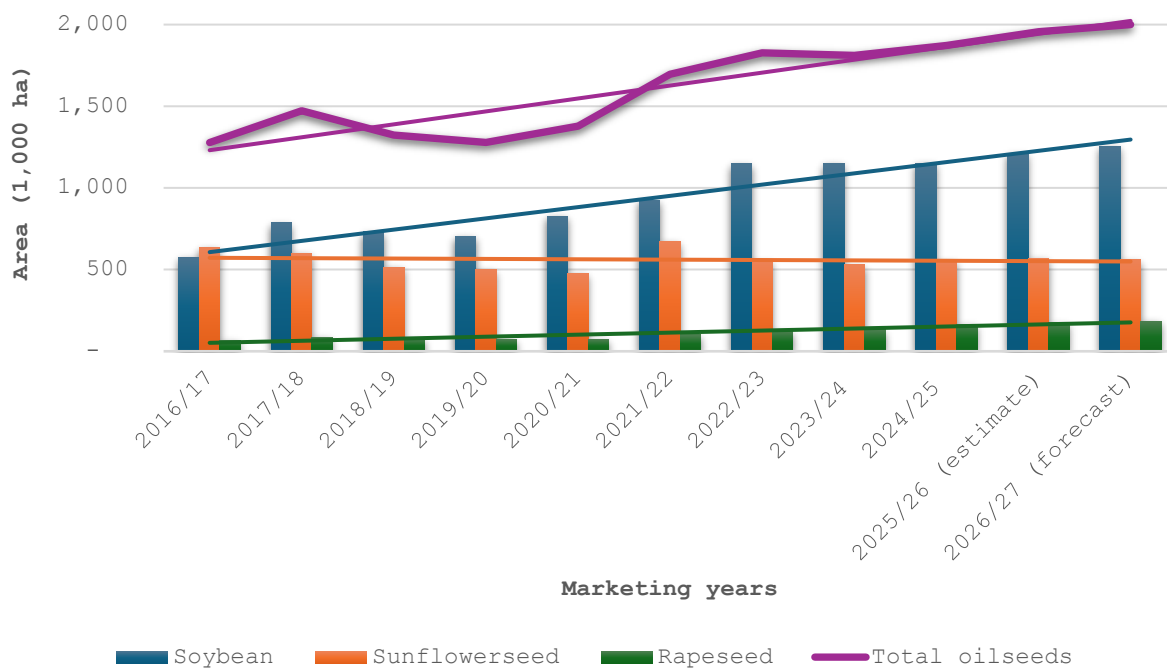
Area Harvested

FAS/Pretoria forecasts that South Africa's total oilseed cultivation will continue to expand in MY² 2026/27, reaching a record 2 million hectares (Mha) (see Figure 1). The sector consists primarily of soybeans, sunflower seed, and rapeseed, grown predominantly under rainfed conditions. Soybeans and sunflower seed are summer rainfall crops concentrated in the northern production regions, while rapeseed is a winter crop produced in the southern, winter rainfall region.

Soybeans account for the largest share of total oilseed area at an estimated 63 percent (see Figure 2), followed by sunflower seed at 28 percent and rapeseed at 9 percent. In MY 2026/27, FAS/Pretoria projects soybean and rapeseed area will increase by 4 percent and 6 percent, respectively, to new records of 1.3 Mha and 185,000 hectares (ha). In contrast, area under sunflower seed is expected to remain unchanged at 560,000 ha (see Figure 2).

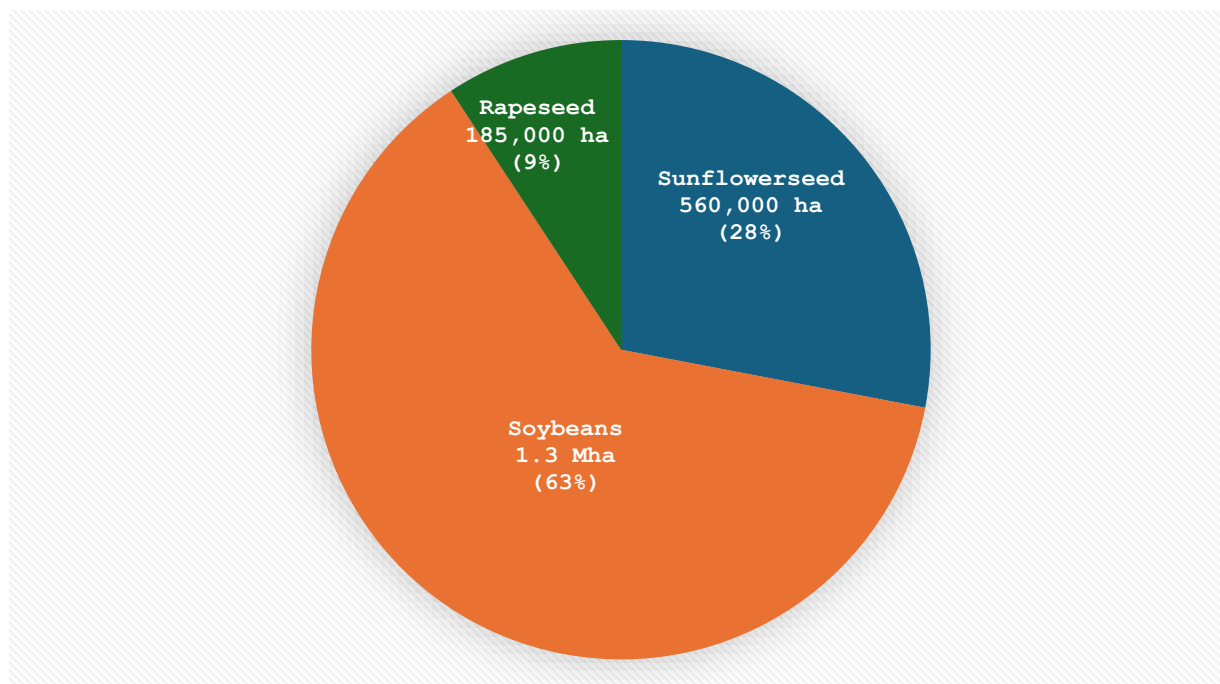
² March 2027 - February 2028 for soybeans and sunflower seed and October 2026 – September 2027 for rapeseed

Figure 1: Trends in Oilseed Area in South Africa



Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from the South Africa Grain Information Services ([SAGIS](#))

Figure 2: Anticipated Oilseed Area in MY 2026/27



Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates

Long Term Trends

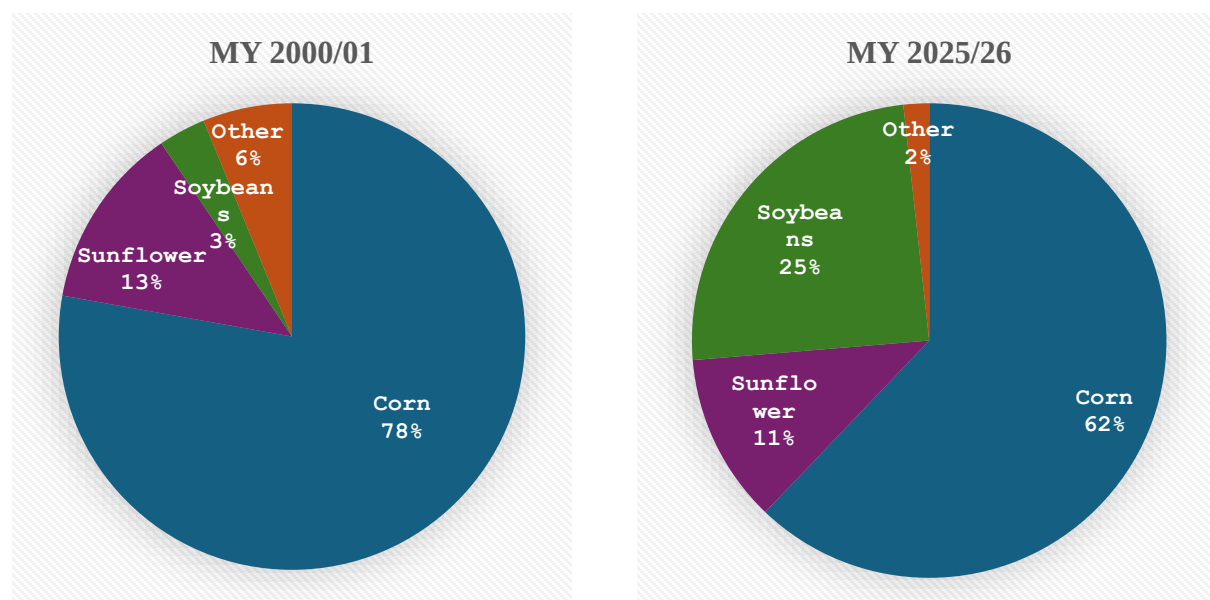
South Africa's summer rainfall production is dominated by three main crops: corn, soybeans, and sunflower. In the winter rainfall region, wheat and rapeseed are the primary crops. Over the past decade, the area planted to summer rainfall crops have trended higher, reaching an estimated 30-year high of 4.9 Mha in MY 2025/26. Winter crop area has expanded, reaching a 17-year high of more than 800,000 ha. In both regions, this increase is largely attributable to oilseeds — soybeans in the summer rainfall areas and rapeseed in the winter rainfall areas — while the grain area has remained relatively stable.

Since 2000, the soybean area has increased more than eightfold, driven by several key factors:

- Rising domestic demand, supported by investments in crushing capacity;
- Increased use of soybeans in crop rotations with corn due to their nitrogen-fixing benefits;
- Availability of higher-yielding cultivars that improve profitability; and
- Relatively lower input costs amid tighter profit margins for competing crops.

In MY 2025/26, farmers planted an estimated record 1.2 Mha of soybeans, representing roughly one-quarter of the total summer rainfall field crop area. Twenty-five years earlier, soybeans accounted for only 3 percent of this area (see Figure 3). With an additional 600,000 metric tons (MT) of annual crushing capacity added during the past two years and emerging export opportunities, FAS/Pretoria expects this upwards trend in soybean area and production to continue in MY 2026/27.

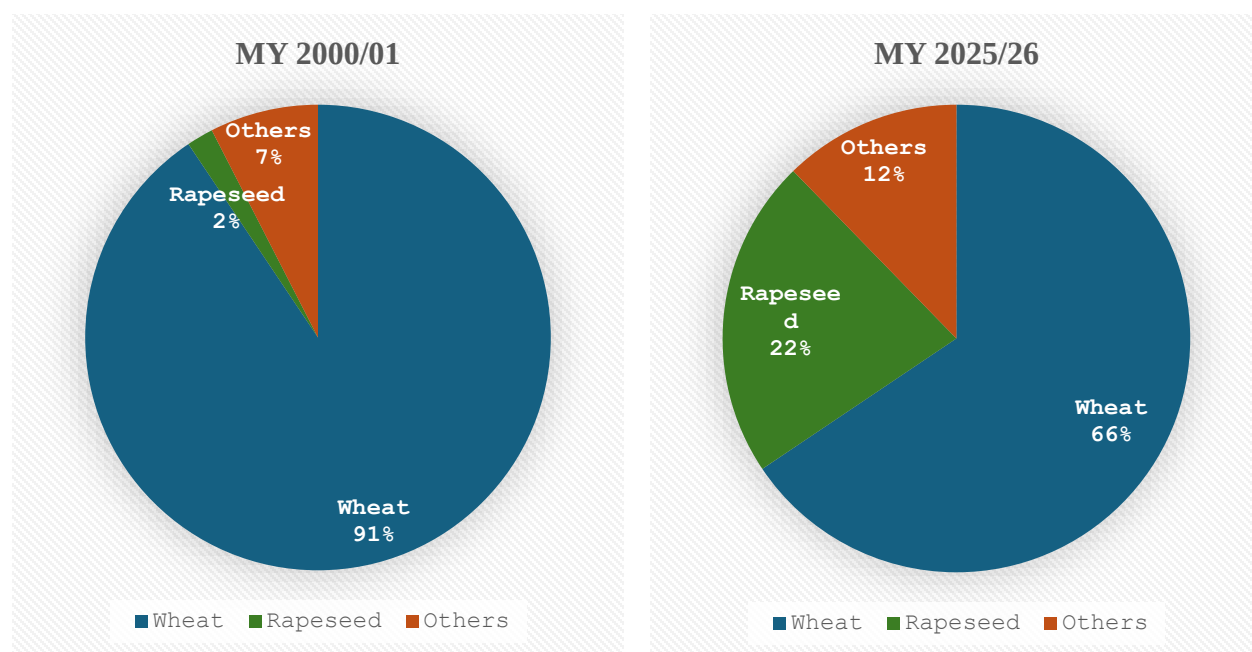
Figure 3: Comparing the Contribution of Various Field Crops to Total Summer Rainfall Area in MY 2000/01 and MY 2025/26



Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from [SAGIS](#)

Rapeseed production in South Africa began in the late 1990s, after the establishment of a rapeseed oil refinery in the Western Cape province. New processing capacity created a market outlet for farmers and stimulated rapid growth in rapeseed cultivation. Since 2000, rapeseed area has increased more than ninefold and now accounts for nearly one-quarter of the winter rainfall crop area, up from just 2 percent twenty-five years ago (see Figure 4). Continued yield gains from improved cultivars, the agronomic benefits of rapeseed as a rotational crop, and strong demand underpinned by expanded crushing capacity are expected to support further growth in MY 2026/27.

Figure 4: Comparing the Contribution of Various Field Crops to Total Winter Rainfall Area in MY 2000/01 and MY 2025/26



Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from [SAGIS](#)

In contrast, sunflower seed area has remained broadly stable for nearly two decades, reflecting the finely balanced nature of the South African sunflower market. Large production increases often push prices toward export parity, a level that is not sustainable for most producers and typically leads to area cutbacks in subsequent seasons. In addition, sunflower yields have not improved as rapidly as those of other commodities, limiting further expansion. FAS/Pretoria therefore expects sunflower area to remain stable in MY 2026/27.

A gradual shift toward high-oil yielding cultivars is anticipated in the future, which could support modest growth in sunflower production. While earlier generations of these cultivars did not match the yields of conventional varieties, recent advancements have achieved yield parity while delivering oil content exceeding 45 percent, compared to the current industry benchmark of 38 percent.

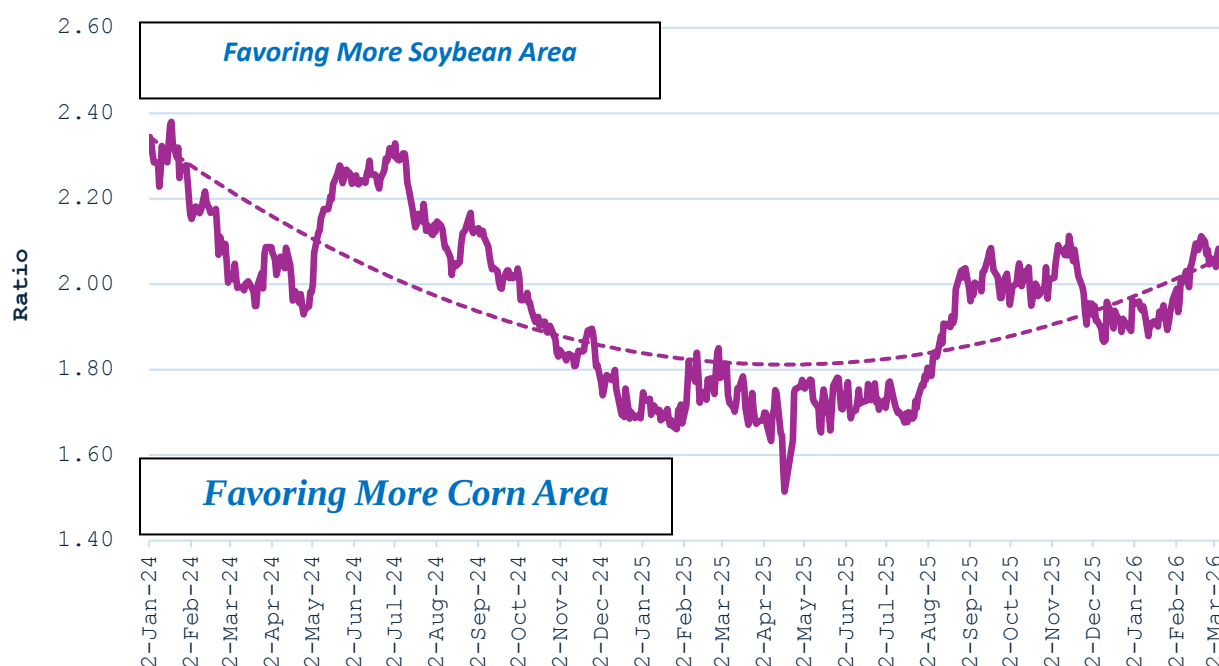
The sunflower area is also affected by intra-seasonal rainfall variability, particularly during the optimal corn and soybean planting windows. Due to the later seasonal planting window of sunflowers, delayed or suboptimal rainfall during the corn and soybeans planting period may prompt producers to reallocate resources to sunflower production as a fallback option in affected years.

Short Term Trends

Crop choice within the total planted area is largely driven by relative profitability and the prevalence of different crop rotation systems by region. The soybean-to-corn price ratio is a widely used indicator of relative returns. A higher ratio favors soybeans, while a lower ratio favors corn. Recent increases in this ratio signal improved relative profitability for soybeans and supports a possible further expansion in soybean plantings (see Figure 5).

Ample carry-over stocks from MY 2024/25, combined with projected corn production exceeding 16 million metric tons (MMT) in MY 2025/26, are expected to keep domestic corn prices subdued through 2026. This bearish price outlook is likely to discourage any meaningful expansion in corn planting area for MY 2026/27, and further support increased soybean cultivation.

Figure 5: *The Trend in the Soybean/Corn Price Ratio for South Africa*



Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from GrainSA

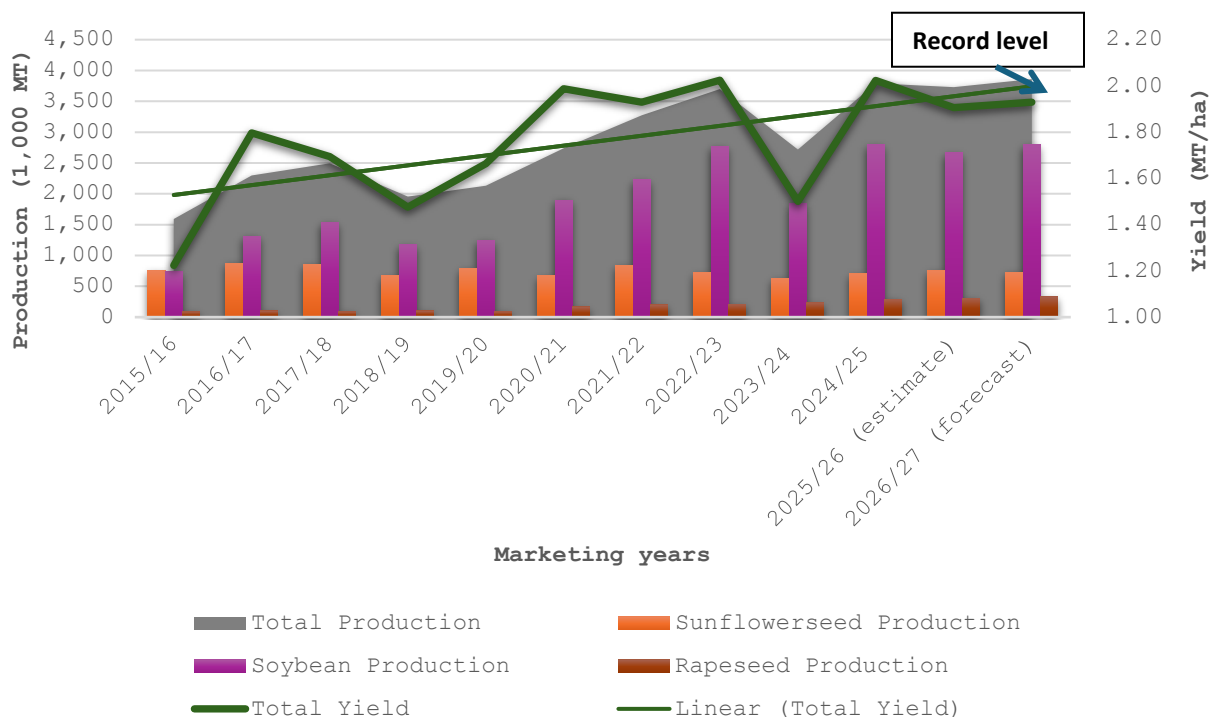
Production

FAS/Pretoria projects a 4 percent increase in South Africa's oilseed production for MY 2026/27, reaching 3.9 MMT, based on expanded planted area, normal weather conditions, and five-year average yields. If realized, this would be South Africa's largest oilseed crop on record. Soybean output is expected to rise 5 percent to 2.8 MMT, while rapeseed production is forecast up 7 percent to a new high of 330,000 MT. In contrast, sunflower seed production is expected to remain stable at around 730,000 MT (see also Figure 6).

The growth in South Africa's oilseed sector is underpinned by continuous improvements in yield potential, driven by the adoption of advanced production technologies such as genetically engineered seed and refined agronomic practices, including the strategic selection of region-specific cultivars. Precision agriculture has been widely embraced by South African farmers, who have invested in supporting technologies to optimize input use and maximize yields. Conservation farming methods, particularly no-till practices, are also gaining traction, especially in Mpumalanga province.

Given that most oilseeds in South Africa are cultivated under rainfed conditions, rainfall variability remains the primary factor influencing yearly yield reductions, as observed in the drought affected MY 2023/24. Nevertheless, the overall trend in yield growth remains positive, supported by ongoing technological and agronomic advancements.

Figure 6: Trends in Production and Yield of Oilseeds in South Africa



Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from [SAGIS](#)

For MY 2025/26, the summer rainfall season started favorably for both soybeans and sunflower seed, with key production regions receiving normal to above-normal rainfall from October through December 2025, largely due to La Niña weather conditions. A subsequent four-week dry spell accompanied by high temperatures from mid-January adversely affected crops, particularly in the eastern Free State and Mpumalanga provinces, where about half of South Africa's soybeans are produced. Widespread rainfall from mid-February helped crops recover. In the western Free State and parts of North West provinces', where water table soils are more common, good early season soil moisture helped mitigate the effects of the dry spell. Less than 10 percent of oilseed production is irrigated, leaving the sector highly dependent on rainfall.

In late February 2026, FAS/Pretoria carried out a five-day mid-season crop assessment across the four main oilseed-producing provinces (see Figure 7). The team conducted crop evaluations and consulted with local agronomists, producers, and industry experts. Based on these field observations and expert consultations, FAS/Pretoria determined that oilseed crops across the region were in fair to excellent condition, with average to above-average yield potential in many areas. Overall, prospects remain positive for another robust oilseed harvest.

This outlook is broadly consistent with the South African Department of Agriculture, Crop Estimates Committee's (CEC) second commercial production estimate for MY 2025/26 summer rainfall crops, released on March 26, 2026. The CEC projects soybean production at 2.7 MMT, the third largest crop on record and only marginally below the 2.8 MMT harvested in the previous marketing year. Sunflower seed production could rise by 8 percent to 778,000 MT.

In August 2025, FAS/Pretoria also assessed crop conditions in the Western Cape province, South Africa's primary winter rainfall production area and the leading region for rapeseed cultivation. Rapeseed is typically planted in May and harvested in November and is almost entirely reliant on rainfall. During this visit, producers reported favorable moisture distribution in 2025, supporting strong vegetative growth and good yield prospects. FAS/Pretoria also met with Southern Oil (SOILL), Africa's largest rapeseed crusher and oil manufacturer, which confirmed favorable rainfall distribution in 2025, supporting strong canola growth and promising yield prospects.

The CEC's final estimate for winter rainfall crops, released on February 26, 2026 (MY 2025/26), confirmed a 6 percent increase in rapeseed production from the 290,000 MT produced in MY 2024/25 to a new record of nearly 310,000 MT. This increase reflects area expansion supported by favorable weather conditions, resulting in firm yields and record output.

Figure 7: *South Africa Mid-season Oilseeds Crop Assessment*



Source: FAS/Pretoria

On February 12, 2026, the Department of Agriculture finalized MY 2024/25 production at 2.8 MMT for soybeans and 700,000 MT for sunflower seed. This is the largest soybean crop on record, 52 percent larger than the drought affected MY 2023/24 crop. Sunflower seed production also rose by 11 percent from the previous marketing year. These estimates include total producer deliveries plus on-farm utilization.

The table below summarizes area, yield, and production for soybeans, sunflower seed, and rapeseed for MY 2024/25 (actual), MY 2025/26 (estimate), and MY 2026/27 (forecast).

Table 4: Area (1,000 ha), Yield (MT/ha), and Production (1,000 MT) of Soybean, Sunflower seed and Rapeseed in South Africa

Oilseeds	Area	Yield	Prod	Area	Yield	Prod	Area	Yield	Prod
	MY 2024/25 (actual)			MY 2025/26 (estimate)			MY 2026/27 (forecast)		
Soybeans	1,151	2.4	2,800	1,213	2.2	2,730	1,255	2.2	2,800
Sunflower seed	556	1.3	700	570	1.4	778	560	1.3	730
Rapeseed	166	1.7	290	175	1.8	309	185	1.8	330
TOTAL	1,873	2.0	3,790	1,958	1.9	3,817	2,000	1.9	3,860

Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from the South African Department of Agriculture

Consumption

Crush

FAS/Pretoria forecasts that South Africa will crush a record 3.3 MMT of oilseeds in both MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27, supported by record local production and recent investments in crushing capacity (see Figure 8). The expansion in domestic soybean production has spurred significant capital investment in processing infrastructure, resulting in an additional 600,000 MT of annual crushing capacity over the past two years. Total soybean and sunflower seed processing capacity is now estimated at about 3.4 MMT, across dedicated soybean and sunflower seed processing facilities, and flexible facilities capable of switching between the two crops. Rapeseed crushing capacity is estimated at around 300,000 MT annually, with further expansion anticipated in response to rising local production. In MY 2024/25, total oilseed crush reached 3.2 MMT, up 17 percent year-on-year, driven mainly by record soybean output.

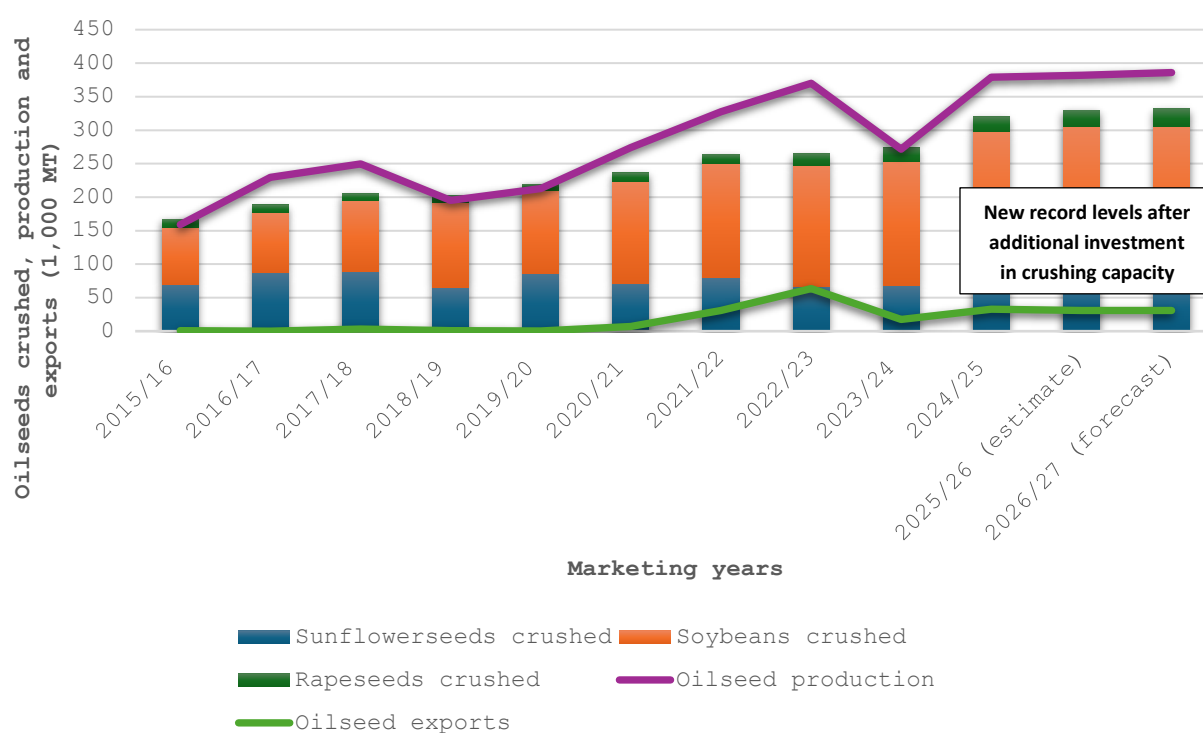
Most soybeans, sunflower seeds, and rapeseed are crushed for both edible oil for human consumption and protein meal for inclusion in animal feed rations. Soybeans are primarily processed for protein meal, which is a key ingredient in animal feed, particularly for feed-

intensive industries such as pork and poultry industries. However, soybean oil is also playing an increasingly important role in South Africa's vegetable oil market, driven by greater availability resulting from higher domestic crushing volumes and a corresponding reduction in the need for imported oils.

In contrast, sunflower seed and rapeseed are higher oil-yielding crops and are predominantly crushed for the vegetable oil market, making them more oriented toward human consumption. However, rapeseed meal also serves as a valuable protein source for animal feed, especially among dairy, pork, and broiler producers in the Western Cape.

Consequently, the demand for oilseeds for crushing is driven by several interrelated factors. Demand is closely linked to the growth of the livestock sector and the corresponding need for animal feed. Additionally, household consumption patterns, consumer disposable incomes, economic and population growth, and changing dietary preferences all significantly influence the overall demand for oilseeds.

Figure 8: Trends in Oilseeds Crushed in South Africa



Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from [SAGIS](#)

Food Use

The direct consumption of soybeans and sunflower seed as food remains limited in South Africa, as neither crop features prominently in traditional diets. FAS/Pretoria does not anticipate significant growth in the human consumption of soybeans or sunflower seed during MY 2026/27 and MY 2025/26.

Feed, Seed, and Waste

Total feed, seed, and waste consumption for the three oilseed commodities is estimated at approximately 215,000 MT in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27.

Table 5 below provides a detailed breakdown of domestic utilization for sunflower seed, soybeans, and rapeseed in South Africa for MY 2024/25 (actual), MY 2025/26 (estimate), and MY 2026/27 (forecast).

Table 5: Sunflower Seed, Soybean, and Rapeseed Utilization in South Africa

Oilseeds (1,000 MT)	Sun- flower	Soy- beans	Rape- seed	Total	Sun- flower	Soy- beans	Rape- seed	Total	Sun- flower	Soy- beans	Rape- seed	Total
	MY 2024/25 (actual)				MY 2025/26 (estimate)				MY 2026/27 (forecast)			
Crush	770	2,210	220	3,200	750	2,300	250	3,300	730	2,320	270	3,320
Food	2	20	0	22	2	20	0	22	2	20	0	22
Feed, seed & waste	10	290	4	304	10	200	5	215	10	200	5	215
Exports	15	247	68	330	20	250	40	310	10	250	50	310
TOTAL	797	2,767	292	3,856	782	2,770	295	3,847	752	2,790	325	3,867
Imports	68	12	0	80	10	0	0	10	20	0	0	20

Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from [SAGIS](#)

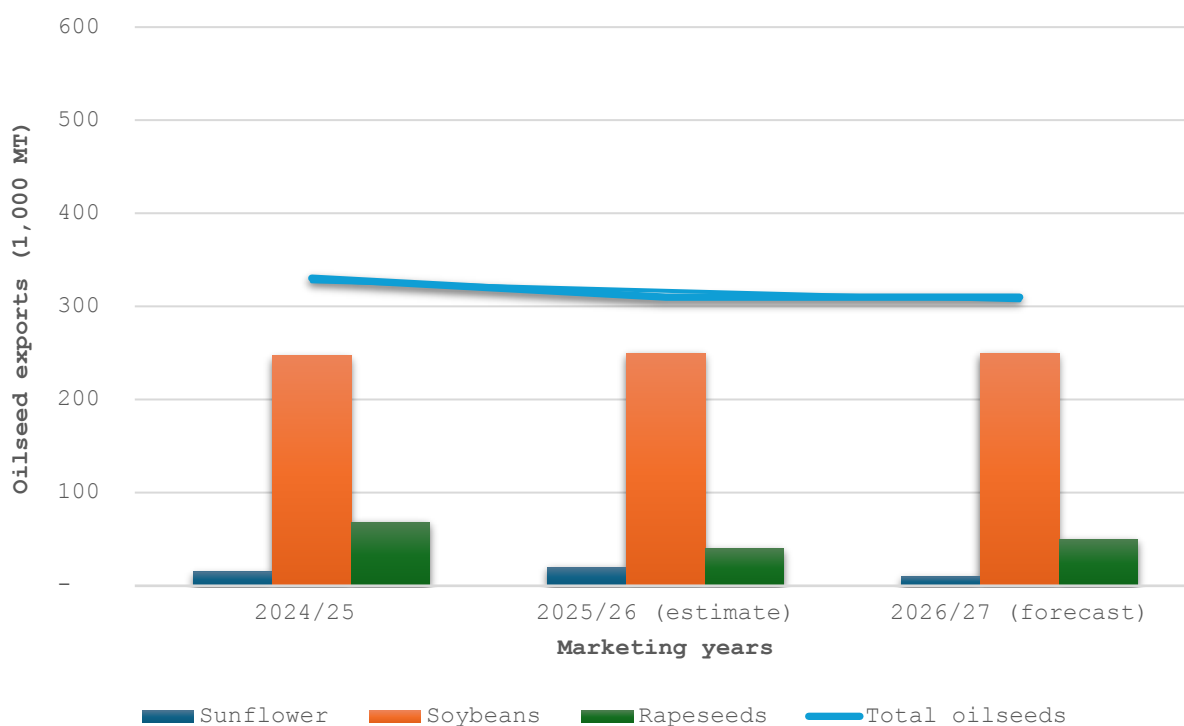
Trade

Exports

FAS/Pretoria projects that South Africa's oilseed exports will remain stable, despite continued historically high production. This is primarily attributed to the expansion of domestic crushing capacity, which is expected to absorb a greater share of locally produced oilseeds (see Figure 9). Nevertheless, oilseed exports will remain notable, with volumes forecast to reach 310,000 MT in both MY 2026/27 and MY 2025/26, driven by regional and global demand. Export protocols concluded with China in 2022 have opened the opportunity for shipments to the world's largest soybean market.

In MY 2024/25, Zimbabwe was the leading destination for South African soybeans, following local production shortfalls caused by drought. Rapeseed exports were mainly shipped to Kenya, while sunflower seed exports went primarily to the Republic of Congo, reflecting regional market dynamics and demand patterns (see Table 6).

Figure 9: *South Africa's Oilseed Exports*



Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from [SAGIS](#)

Table 6: South Africa's Oilseeds Exports in MY 2024/25

MY 2024/25				
<u>Countries</u>	<u>Soybean</u>	<u>Sunflower</u>	<u>Rapeseed</u>	<u>Total</u>
(1,000 MT)				
<u>Export Destinations</u>				
Zimbabwe	207	-	-	200
Kenya	-	-	68	68
Eswatini	40	-	-	40
Republic of the Congo	-	15	-	15
Total Exports	247	15	68	330

Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from [SAGIS](#)

Imports

FAS/Pretoria anticipates that South African oilseed imports will remain limited in MY 2026/27 and MY 2025/26, as domestic production is expected to surpass local utilization requirements. This trend reflects South Africa's growing self-sufficiency in oilseed production, supported by expanded area and improved yields. In MY 2024/25, South Africa imported a total of 80,000 MT of oilseeds, including 10,000 MT of soybeans from the United States and 67,000 MT of sunflower seed from Argentina.

Oilseed Import Duties

South Africa's current import duties on oilseeds were established in the early 2000s and have remained unchanged since their implementation. U.S. soybean exports to South Africa are subject to an 8 percent import duty. By contrast, the Economic Partnership Agreement (EPA) between the Southern African Customs Union (SACU) and the European Union (EU) and United Kingdom (UK) provides duty-free access for oilseeds from these partners. Additionally, the existing tariff schedule permits duty-free importation of oilseeds from South Africa's neighboring countries (see Table 7).

Table 7: South Africa's Import Duties for Oilseeds

Products (HS Code)	General (including the United States)	EU/UK	European Free Trade Association (EFTA)	Southern Africa Development Community (SADC)	Mercosur
<i>Rate of Duty on the FOB Price</i>					
<u>Soybeans</u> (1201)	8%	Free	8%	Free	8%
<u>Sunflower seed</u> (1206)	9.4%	Free	9.4%	Free	9.4%
<u>Rapeseed</u> (1205)	10%	Free	10%	Free	7.5%

Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from the South African Revenue Services

Stocks

Year-end stocks for each of the major oilseeds are projected to stabilize at levels sufficient to cover approximately one month of commercial utilization throughout the three marketing years covered in this report. This level of stockholding is expected to support market stability and ensure a reliable supply for processors and end-users.

South Africa's grain and oilseed storage capacity exceeds 20 MMT and includes the traditional long-term concrete towers, flexible storage systems like bunkers and silo bags and galvanized steel bins, mainly for on-farm storage. Stocks are primarily held by producer-owned agribusinesses (formerly cooperatives), traders, processors and farmers. The South African government exercises minimal intervention in the domestic oilseed market. Consequently, the government does not maintain oilseed reserves or impose regulatory requirements for minimum stock levels.

Oilseed Meals

Table 8: Soybean Meal Production, Supply, and Distribution

Meal, Soybean Market Year Begins South Africa	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
	Mar 2025		Mar 2026		Mar 2027	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	1825	2210	1850	2300	0	2320
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.8	0.7964	0.8	0.7957	0	0.7974
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	193	193	163	328	0	338
Production (1000 MT)	1460	1760	1480	1830	0	1850
MY Imports (1000 MT)	100	80	300	30	0	30
Total Supply (1000 MT)	1753	2033	1943	2188	0	2218
MY Exports (1000 MT)	220	230	200	350	0	350
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	45	0	50	0	50
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	1370	1430	1530	1450	0	1480
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	1370	1475	1530	1500	0	1530
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	163	328	213	338	0	338
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	1753	2033	1943	2188	0	2218
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Table 9: Sunflower seed Meal Production, Supply, and Distribution

Meal, Sunflower seed Market Year Begins South Africa	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
	Mar 2025		Mar 2026		Mar 2027	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	750	770	725	750	0	730
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.4253	0.4156	0.4248	0.42	0	0.4219
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	15	15	27	26	0	26
Production (1000 MT)	319	320	308	315	0	308
MY Imports (1000 MT)	10	1	40	0	0	0
Total Supply (1000 MT)	344	336	375	341	0	334
MY Exports (1000 MT)	30	30	15	20	0	20
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	287	280	330	295	0	290
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	287	280	330	295	0	290
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	27	26	30	26	0	24
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	344	336	375	341	0	334
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
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Table 10: Rapeseed Meal Production, Supply, and Distribution

Meal, Rapeseed Market Year Begins South Africa	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
	Oct 2025		Oct 2026		Oct 2027	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	175	220	210	250	0	270
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.5829	0.5545	0.581	0.548	0	0.5519
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	6	6	8	8	0	10
Production (1000 MT)	102	122	122	137	0	149
MY Imports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Supply (1000 MT)	108	128	130	145	0	159
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	100	120	122	135	0	150
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	100	120	122	135	0	150
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	8	8	8	10	0	9
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	108	128	130	145	0	159
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
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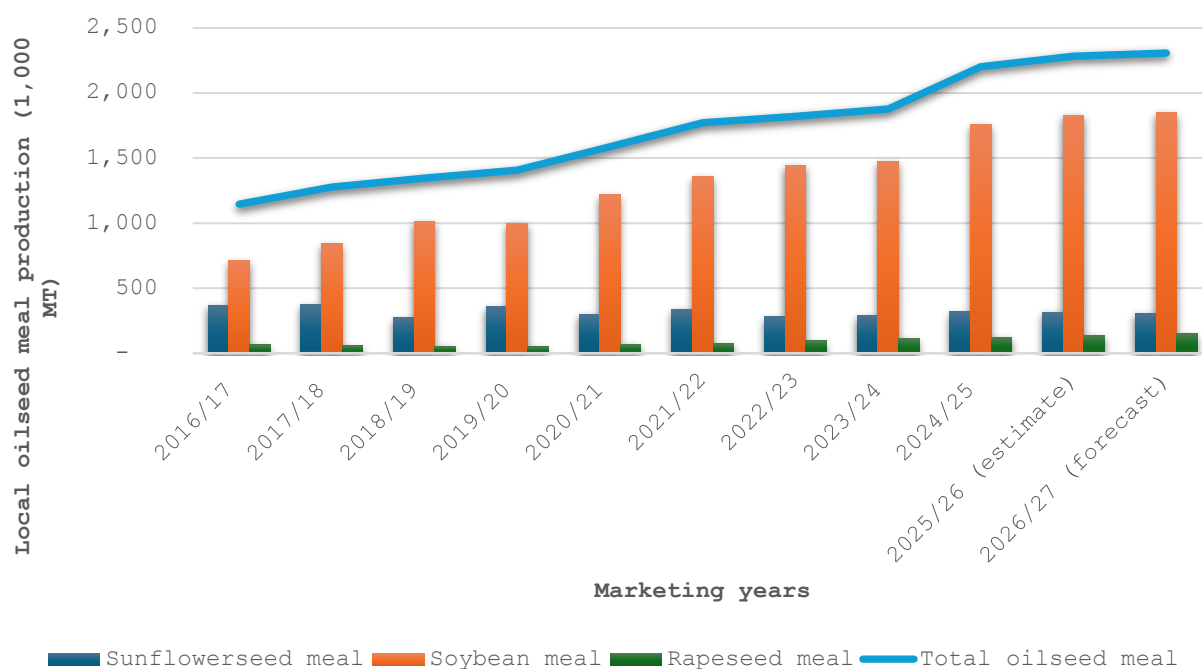
Production

FAS/Pretoria projects that South Africa's oilseed meal production will reach record levels of 2.3 MMT in both MY 2025/26 and 2026/27, assuming optimal crushing capacity utilization. Figure 10 illustrates the upward trend in oilseed meal production, which has been driven by increased investments in local oilseed processing capacity over the years.

Table 11 presents the production figures for soybean, sunflower seed, and rapeseed meal in South Africa for MY 2024/25 (actual), MY 2025/26 (estimate), and MY 2026/27 (forecast). Industry-standard extraction rates are 42 percent for sunflower seed, 80 percent for soybean, and 55 percent for rapeseed.

Looking ahead, sustained growth in oilseed production has the potential to attract additional investment in processing infrastructure, as stakeholders aim to leverage increased supply and enhance value addition within the sector. However, a subdued macroeconomic outlook may temper investor enthusiasm and limit the scale or pace of new investments in the near term.

Figure 10: Trends in Oilseed Meal Production in South Africa



Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from [SAGIS](#)

Table 11: Oilseed Meal Production in South Africa

Marketing years	Crushed (1,000 MT)			Meal produced (1,000 MT)		
	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27
Sunflower seed (42% meal)	770	750	730	320	315	308
Soybean (80% meal)	2,210	2,300	2,320	1,760	1,830	1,850
Rapeseed (55% meal)	220	250	270	122	137	149
TOTAL	3,200	3,300	3,320	2,202	2,282	2,307

Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from [SAGIS](#)

Feed Consumption

FAS/Pretoria projects marginal growth in the feed consumption of soybean, sunflower seed, and rapeseed meal, reaching 1.9 MMT in both MY 2026/27 and MY 2025/26 (Table 12). South Africa's ongoing economic challenges are expected to constrain growth in consumer demand for poultry and livestock products, thereby limiting significant expansion in demand for animal feed.

Additionally, the frequency and severity of animal disease outbreaks also weigh on feed demand. In 2023, the outbreak of highly pathogenic avian influenza (HPAI) resulted in the culling of nearly 10 million birds, impacting the feed requirements in the poultry sector. At present, South Africa is contending with its most prolonged and severe outbreak of foot-and-mouth disease (FMD) among cattle, which has also affected feedlot operations. The pork industry continues to face the ongoing threat of African Swine Fever (ASF), posing further risks to production stability. These recurring animal health challenges not only disrupt livestock production but also contribute to volatility in feed demand and broader market uncertainty.

Table 12: Soybean Meal, Sunflower seed Meal and Rapeseed Meal Consumption in South Africa

Oilseeds meals	Marketing years		
	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27
	(1,000 MT)		
Soybean meal	1,430	1,450	1,480
Sunflower seed meal	280	295	290
Rapeseed meal	120	135	150
TOTAL	1,830	1,880	1,920

Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from AFMA

Table 13: Meal Demand in South Africa as Soybean Meal Equivalent (SME)

Marketing year			
Meals	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27
(1,000 MT)			
Soybean	1,430	1,450	1,480
Sunflower seed	187	197	193
Rapeseed	85	96	107
Fish	15	17	15
Cotton	10	10	10
TOTAL	1,727	1,770	1,805

Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from AFMA

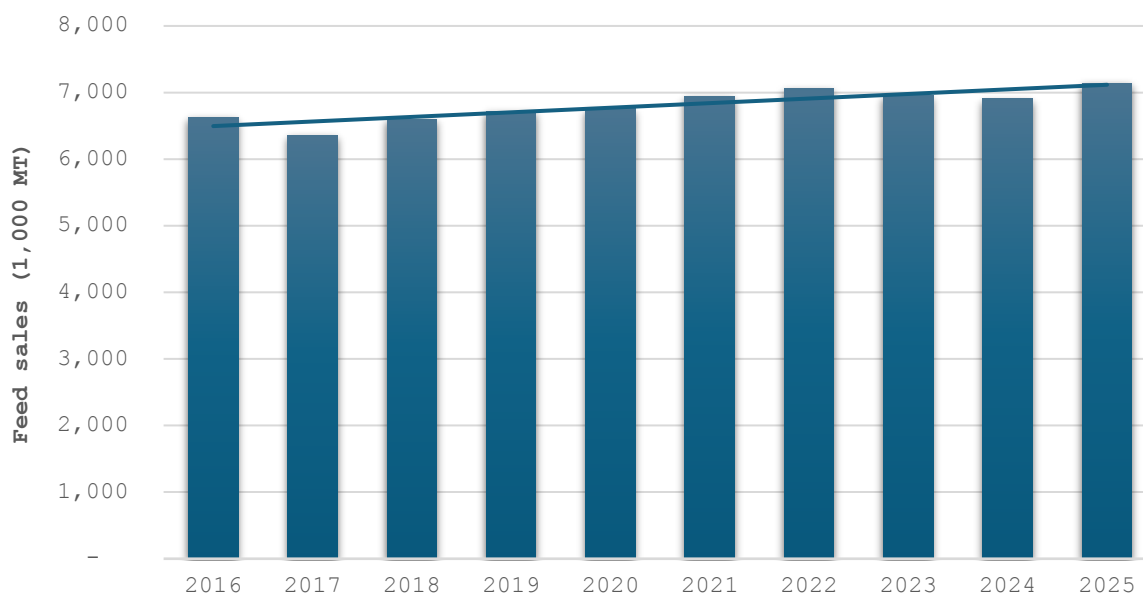
According to the Animal Feed Manufacturing Association of South Africa (AFMA), feed sales have recorded a compound annual growth rate of approximately 1 percent over the past decade (see Figure 11). AFMA members collectively represent about 60 percent of all formal animal feed production in South Africa.

Oilseed meal is the primary protein source in animal feed manufacturing. Among these, soybean meal is the predominant protein ingredient used by feed manufacturers in South Africa, typically accounting for more than 70 percent of total protein meal usage (see Table 12). Combined, soybean meal and sunflower seed meal constitute approximately 85 percent of the protein component in animal feed formulations. The average inclusion rate of protein meal in feed rations ranges between 20 and 30 percent.

Corn remains the principal carbohydrate source for feed manufacturers, with an inclusion rate exceeding 50 percent in most feed rations. The use of fishmeal as a protein source is influenced by its availability, the specific product mix, and its price relative to other protein sources. However, in recent years, the inclusion rate of fishmeal by South African feed manufacturers has been minimal, at less than one percent.

While soybean meal consumption has continued to grow over the past decade, supported by improved domestic supply, sunflower meal consumption has remained largely stagnant. This limited growth is attributable to both compressed sunflower production and the restricted use of sunflower meal in poultry feed rations, which represent the largest segment of feed demand. Rapeseed meal is a valuable protein source for animal feed, particularly for dairy, pork, and broiler producers in the Western Cape, where it is produced. Rapeseed meal usage is expected to increase in line with rapeseed production.

Figure 11: Annual Feed Sales in South Africa



Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from AFMA

Looking ahead, any substantial increase in feed consumption will likely depend on improvements in the broader economic environment and renewed growth in the livestock and poultry sectors. Potential future investments in feed manufacturing capacity may be contingent on these market conditions and the pace of recovery in consumer demand.

Though South Africa's medium-term economic outlook remains subdued (see Figure 12). The country's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) expanded by only 1.1 percent in 2025, with projected growth rates below 1.5 percent for both 2026 and 2027. Purchasing power—defined as the disposable income available to the population—has declined in recent years. Additionally, the unemployment rate remains elevated at over 30 percent, further constraining consumption growth.

South Africa's weak economic growth is the result of several persistent and interrelated challenges. Policy uncertainty, particularly regarding regulatory frameworks and land reform, has contributed to investor hesitation. Logistical infrastructure challenges, including inefficiencies at ports, railways, and road networks, impede the smooth movement of goods and increase operational costs. Additionally, a declining investment climate—exacerbated by concerns over governance, corruption, safety, and bureaucratic delays—further discourages both domestic and foreign investment. These factors, combined with high unemployment and skills shortages, significantly hinder the country's economic growth and development.

Figure 12: GDP Growth, Purchasing Power and Population Growth in South Africa



Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from the World Bank and StatsSA

Industrial Consumption

South Africa does not consume any significant volume of oilseed meal for industrial (non-feed) purposes.

Food Use

South Africa produces textured vegetable protein (TVP) from crushing soybeans, which is supplied to food companies as an input for various food value chains. However, domestic production of TVP remains limited. According to SAGIS, South Africa produced approximately 45,000 MT of TVP in MY 2024/25. FAS/Pretoria predicts that it could reach 50,000 MT in MY 2026/27 and MY 2025/26.

Industry experts have identified several challenges that constrain the growth of TVP usage in food products in South Africa. These include prevailing consumer perceptions that soy-based products are inferior, as well as a lack of targeted consumer education. Enhanced outreach is needed to inform consumers about the benefits of incorporating soy-based products into meals, such as increasing protein content and improving meal bulk. Addressing these challenges could support greater adoption of TVP in the South African food sector.

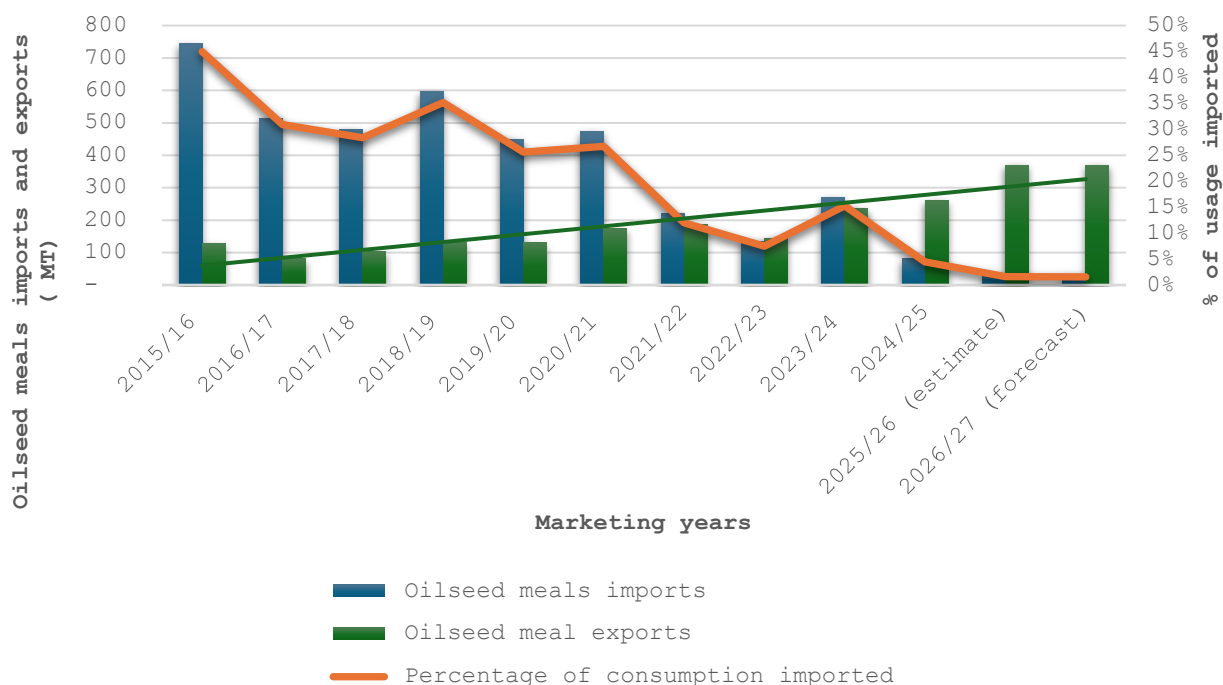
Trade

Imports

FAS/Pretoria projects that South Africa's oilseed meal imports will decline to 30,000 MT in both MY 2026/27 and MY 2025/26, as record domestic production and only modest growth in local consumption reduce import growth. Figure 13 demonstrates the downward trend in oilseed meal imports alongside rising exports, positioning South Africa as a net exporter of oilseed meal following significant investments in expanding local crushing capacity.

Imports are expected to remain concentrated in coastal regions. Given the deteriorating rail and road infrastructure between the interior and the coast, it is often more cost-effective to import soybean meal into the Western Cape than to transport domestic product from inland crushing plants.

Figure 13: South Africa's Oilseed Meal Imports and Exports



Sources: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data Trade Data Monitor LLC

Exports

FAS/Pretoria forecasts that South Africa will export a record 370,000 MT of oilseed meal in MY 2026/27 and MY 2025/26, representing approximately 16 percent of domestic production. As domestic meal production grows faster than local demand, the resulting surpluses are exported, supporting both industry utilization and foreign exchange earnings. These exports will primarily be directed to neighboring countries and include mostly soybean meal, reflecting South Africa's

growing role as a regional supplier. Oilseed meal exports are estimated to reach around 260,000 MT in MY 2024/25, up 10 percent from the previous marketing year.

Oilseed Meal Import Duties

Table 14 outlines the import duties applicable to oilseed meal imports into South Africa, with a standard duty rate of 6.6 percent for most oilseed meal products. Under the EPA between the SACU and the EU and UK, oilseed meal imports from these markets are exempt from duties. Additionally, the current tariff schedule permits duty-free imports of oilseed meal from South Africa's neighboring countries.

Table 14: *South Africa's Import Tariffs for Oilseed Meal*

Products (HS Code)	General (including the United States)	EU/UK	European Free Trade Association (EFTA)	Southern Africa Development Community (SADC)	Mercosur
<u>Soybean meal</u>					
2304	6.6%	Free	6.6%	Free	4.95%
230250	Free	Free	Free	Free	Free
120810	20%	Free	20%	Free	20%
<u>Sunflower seed meal</u>					
230630	6.6%	Free	6.6%	Free	6.6%
<u>Rapeseed meal</u>					
230641	6.6%	Free	6.6%	Free	6.6%
230649	6.6%	Free	6.6%	Free	6.6%

Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from the South African Revenue Services

Stocks

Oilseed meal stocks are expected to remain relatively stable throughout the reporting period, largely due to increased local production. These stocks are privately owned and generally represent one to two months of supply, based on average consumption levels, and the limited storage abilities of protein meals.

Oils

Table 15: Soybean Oil Production, Supply, and Distribution

Oil, Soybean Market Year Begins South Africa	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
	Mar 2025		Mar 2026		Mar 2027	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	1825	2210	1850	2300	0	2320
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.1748	0.1792	0.1805	0.18	0	0.1797
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	20	20	29	31	0	30
Production (1000 MT)	319	396	334	414	0	417
MY Imports (1000 MT)	30	30	50	25	0	25
Total Supply (1000 MT)	369	446	413	470	0	472
MY Exports (1000 MT)	85	85	75	100	0	90
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	255	330	310	340	0	350
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	255	330	310	340	0	350
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	29	31	28	30	0	32
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	369	446	413	470	0	472
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
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Table 16: Sunflower Oil Production, Supply, and Distribution

Oil, Sunflower seed Market Year Begins South Africa	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
	Mar 2025		Mar 2026		Mar 2027	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	750	770	725	750	0	730
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.4173	0.3792	0.4179	0.38	0	0.3795
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	29	29	32	36	0	41
Production (1000 MT)	313	292	303	285	0	277
MY Imports (1000 MT)	160	130	185	130	0	135
Total Supply (1000 MT)	502	451	520	451	0	453
MY Exports (1000 MT)	60	65	65	60	0	60
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	410	350	420	350	0	350
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	410	350	420	350	0	350
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	32	36	35	41	0	43
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	502	451	520	451	0	453
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
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Table 17: Rapeseed Oil Production, Supply, and Distribution

Oil, Rapeseed Market Year Begins South Africa	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
	Oct 2025		Oct 2026		Oct 2027	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	175	220	210	250	0	270
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.4229	0.4182	0.4238	0.42	0	0.4185
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	5	5	8	8	0	10
Production (1000 MT)	74	92	89	105	0	113
MY Imports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Supply (1000 MT)	79	97	97	113	0	123
MY Exports (1000 MT)	1	4	1	8	0	13
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	70	85	88	95	0	100
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	70	85	88	95	0	100
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	8	8	8	10	0	10
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	79	97	97	113	0	123
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Production

FAS/Pretoria projects that South Africa's domestic production of oilseed oils will reach record levels of more than 800,000 MT in both MY 2026/27 and MY 2025/26, driven by increased availability of crushing stocks. Table 18 presents the production figures for soybean, sunflower, and rapeseed oil in South Africa for MY 2024/25 (actual), MY 2025/26 (estimate), and MY 2026/27 (forecast). The estimated oil extraction rates are 38 percent for sunflower seed, 18 percent for soybeans, and 42 percent for rapeseed.

This anticipated growth in local oilseed oil production will help South Africa meet a greater share of its domestic demand for edible oils; however, the country is not yet self-sufficient and will continue to rely on imports to supplement local supply. Continued investment in processing infrastructure and improvements in agricultural productivity is expected to support further increases in production, but import requirements are likely to persist in the medium term to satisfy total market needs.

Table 18: Oilseed Oil Production in South Africa

Marketing years	Crushed (1,000 MT)			Oil produced (1,000 MT)		
	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27
Sunflower (38% oil)	770	750	730	292	285	277
Soybean (18% oil)	2,210	2,300	2,320	396	414	417
Rapeseed (42% oil)	220	250	270	92	105	113
TOTAL	3,200	3,300	3,320	780	804	807

Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from [SAGIS](#)

Food Consumption

FAS/Pretoria estimates that South Africa's plant oil consumption will reach approximately 1.3 MMT in MY 2026/27. However, growth prospects remain limited due to ongoing economic challenges and constrained economic progress. As previously noted, South Africa continues to face significant economic headwinds, including a high cost of living and an unemployment rate exceeding 30 percent (see Figure 12). These factors are expected to restrict growth in consumer demand for plant oils, as demand is closely linked to changes in consumer purchasing power. The country's medium-term economic outlook remains subdued, further limiting the potential for increased plant oil consumption.

Plant oil imports continue to play a critical role in South Africa's edible oil market, particularly within the food service sector, where palm oil is favored as a frying oil due to its affordability and favorable heating properties. South Africa lacks the agro-ecological conditions necessary for domestic palm oil production and is therefore entirely reliant on imports, primarily from Indonesia and Malaysia. Palm oil imports have increased over the past decade but are expected to stabilize at around 500,000 MT as domestic soybean processing capacity expands. Rapid growth in soybean processing has contributed meaningfully to the substitution of imported vegetable oils (see Figure 14).

Palm oil currently accounts for about 37 percent of total plant oil consumption in South Africa, a share that is expected to remain stable over the reporting period. Table 19 provides estimated consumption figures for soybean oil, sunflower oil, rapeseed oil, palm oil, and other edible oils in South Africa for MY 2024/25, MY 2025/26, and MY 2026/27.

Table 19: *The Estimated Consumption of Plant Oils in South Africa*

Plant oils	Marketing year		
	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27
(1,000 MT)			
Sunflower oil	350	350	350
Soybean oil	330	340	350
Rapeseed oil	85	95	100
Palm oil	465	465	475
Other oils	10	10	10
TOTAL	1,240	1,260	1,285

Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from Trade Data Monitor LLC

Industrial Consumption

South Africa does not use a significant volume of vegetable oil for industrial (non-food) purposes.

South Africa's Biofuels Industrial Strategy, introduced in 2007, set a target to replace 2 percent of the country's liquid transportation fuels with bioethanol—primarily derived from sugar cane and sugar beet—and biodiesel produced from feedstocks such as soybeans, sunflower seed, and rapeseed. The strategy aimed to promote rural development, stimulate job creation, and achieve measurable reductions in greenhouse gas emissions.

However, implementation has lagged. Frequent policy delays, the absence of mandatory blending requirements, and a complex regulatory environment has discouraged investment and slowed project development. As a result, South Africa's biofuels sector remains largely underdeveloped, with limited progress toward achieving the strategy's intended goals of energy diversification and socio-economic advancement.

Trade

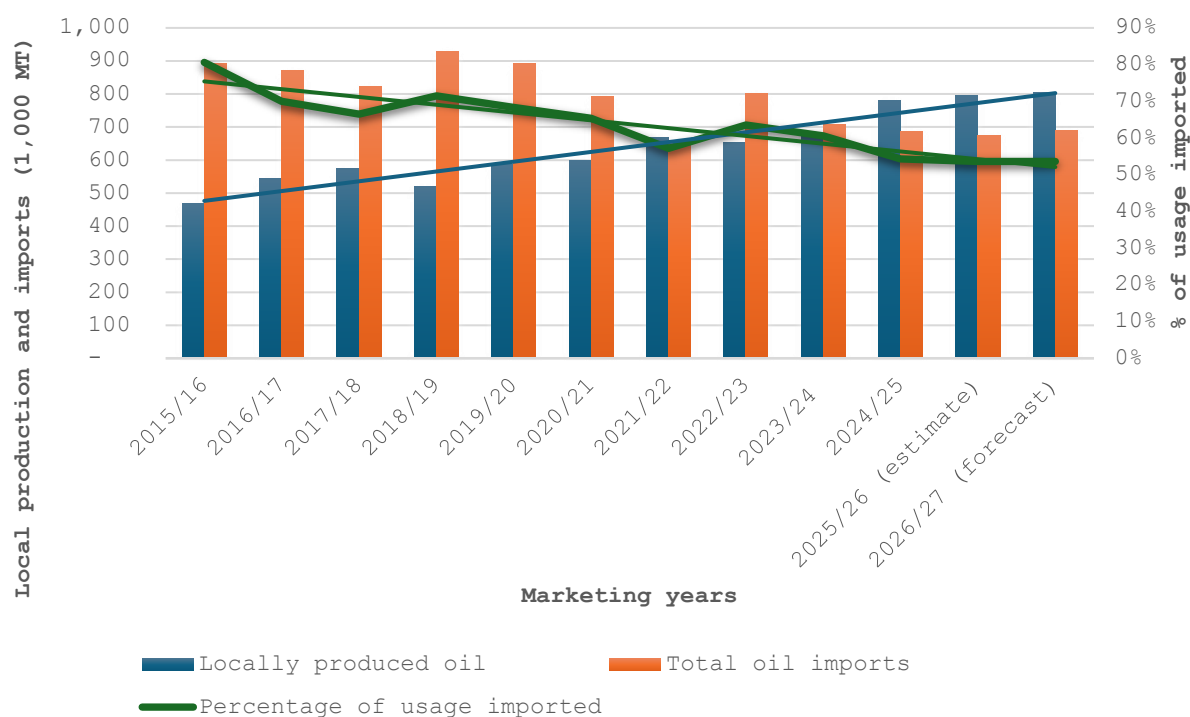
Imports

The share of imported plant oils in South Africa's total domestic consumption has declined meaningfully over the past decade, falling from 80 percent to an anticipated 54 percent in MY

2026/27, driven by expanded local crushing capacity (see Figure 14). Nonetheless, imported plant oils will remain a vital component of South Africa's edible oil market for the foreseeable future. FAS/Pretoria projects that South Africa will import approximately 700,000 MT of plant oils in MY 2026/27, with palm oil accounting for more than 70 percent of these imports.

Imports of sunflower oil and soybean oil are expected to remain steady at 135,000 MT and 25,000 MT, respectively, reflecting both increased domestic production and limited growth in local demand. In MY 2024/25, Bulgaria and Argentina were the primary suppliers of sunflower oil to South Africa, while the Netherlands and Argentina accounted for most soybean oil imports.

Figure 14: Trends in South Africa's Local Production and Imports of Edible Oils



Source: FAS/Pretoria estimates and data from Trade Data Monitor LLC

Exports

South Africa exports approximately 20 percent, or around 160,000 MT, of domestically produced oilseed oils to neighboring countries each year. FAS/Pretoria anticipates that these export levels will be maintained in MY 2026/27 and 2025/26, supported by stable local oilseed oil production and consistent regional demand.

The primary export markets for South African oilseed oils are countries within the Southern African Development Community (SADC), where demand for edible oils continues to expand. Sustained local production of oilseeds, combined with ongoing investments in domestic crushing capacity, is expected to strengthen South Africa's role as a key regional supplier of oilseed oils.

Most exports are channeled through South African retail and food distribution companies that have expanded their footprint across Southern Africa. These firms leverage established logistics networks, brand recognition, and operational expertise to access new markets and ensure consistent product availability. South Africa's comparatively advanced retail food infrastructure provides a distinct competitive advantage, enabling efficient distribution, inventory management, and after-sales support throughout the region. This integrated commercial and logistical presence strengthens South Africa's position as a regional hub for sourcing, processing, and distributing oilseed-based products.

Oilseed Oil Import Duties

Table 20 outlines the import duties applicable to oilseed oil imports into South Africa. In general, a 10 percent import duty is levied on most imported oilseed oils. However, under the EPA between SACU and both the EU and the UK, oilseed oils originating from these markets are eligible for duty-free entry into South Africa. Additionally, the current tariff schedule permits duty-free imports of oilseed oil from SADC countries.

Table 20: South Africa's Import Tariffs for Oilseed Oils

Products (HS Code)	General (including the United States)	EU/UK	European Free Trade Association (EFTA)	Southern Africa Development Community (SADC)	Mercosur
<u>Soybean oil</u>					
1507	10%	Free	10%	Free	10%
<u>Sunflower seed oil</u>					
151211	10%	Free	10%	Free	10%
151219	10%	Free	10%	Free	10%
<u>Rapeseed oil</u>					
1514	10%	Free	10%	Free	10%

Source: FAS/Pretoria using data from the South African Revenue Services

Stocks

No significant fluctuations are anticipated in sunflower oil, soybean oil, or rapeseed oil stocks over the reporting period. Current stock levels typically cover about four weeks of domestic consumption and are held by private sector entities, including food processors, retailers, and traders.

This relatively stable stockholding pattern reflects efficient supply chain management and a well-established distribution network. Maintaining these inventory levels helps ensure continuity of supply and mitigates the risk of short-term disruptions in the edible oil market.

Attachments:

No Attachments